

FUTURE CFO 2035 · 02 SEPTEMBER 2026

When Scope 3 Outruns the P&L

A mid-cap Indian CFO, an IIM Bangalore reading of 982 BRSR filings, and the FY 2026–27 morning when assurance stops being someone else’s problem.

Teaching case prepared by Dr. Debasis Pahi, Assistant Professor, Model Degree College Malkangiri; Ph.D., IIT Kharagpur. Research programme: Corporate Governance, Capital Structure, ESG and Sustainable Finance. Created and Copyright by Dr. Debasis Pahi. For classroom use. Figures are drawn only from public primary sources cited at the end. The company and the officers named below are teaching composites; the statutes, studies and statistics are not.

“While ESG reporting has become an established corporate practice, long-term sustainability leadership will be determined by an organization’s ability to translate commitments into measurable outcomes, supported by robust governance, independent assurance, and the integration of sustainability into core business strategy—rather than compliance alone.”

— IIM Bangalore, Supply Chain Management Centre, Business Responsibility and Sustainability in India, August 2026

“Listed entities shall mandatorily undertake assessment or assurance of the BRSR Core, as per the glide path... FY 2026–27: Top 1,000 listed entities (by market capitalisation).”

— SEBI / stock-exchange master-circular language following the Board decision of 18 December 2024

I. A Tuesday in Bistupur

Jamshedpur, 2 September 2026, 7:40 a.m.

Ananya Rao printed the Business Today clip twice. Once for the board pack. Once for herself. The headline did the usual work of a headline: it compressed a year of filings into a single insult. “Top 1,000 listed Indian companies see 53% jump in FY25 carbon emissions: IIM-Bangalore study.” She circled the sentence that actually mattered to a CFO who still closed books on the fifteenth working day: more than half of the country’s largest listed firms had increased their operational greenhouse-gas footprint, and 57.1 percent had filed nothing at all on Scope 3.

Rao was Chief Financial Officer of Meridian Castings Limited, a teaching composite assembled from the common facts of a mid-cap Indian foundry and precision-component maker: listed on the NSE, family-promoted with a professional board, export-facing customers in automotive and capital goods, and a market capitalisation that drifted across the SEBI “top 1,000” line depending on the month. In FY 2025–26 Meridian had sat inside the top 500 on some ranking days and outside it on others. The company secretary kept a spreadsheet. The bankers kept a longer one.

The board met on 13 September. Four items were already locked: the Q1 review, a working-capital renewal with a public-sector bank that had begun asking climate questions in the information memorandum, a capex note on a heat-treatment line, and “BRSR Core — FY 2026–27 readiness.” Rao had asked for forty

minutes on the last item. The chair had given her twenty.

She put the IIMB monograph and the SEBI glide path on the same page of her own notes. One document described what India Inc. had actually disclosed for FY 2024–25. The other described what the next twelve months would demand of anyone who wanted to remain in the listed club without an asterisk. Between those two pages sat the thing she was paid for: a recommendation.

II. What the filings actually said

The Supply Chain Management Centre at the Indian Institute of Management Bangalore published, with a copyright date of August 2026 and a publication date of 1 August 2026, a study titled Business Responsibility and Sustainability in India: a comprehensive analysis of BRSR disclosures of India's top 1,000 listed companies for FY 2024–25. The effective sample was 982 companies with valid and sufficiently complete filings, classified across 22 sectors under the NSE's standardised framework. The Centre's own summary, later carried in the business press on 30 August, is the source of every operational figure used in this case.

Absolute Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions climbed 4.29 percent year on year. That aggregate hides the political sentence: 53.1 percent of companies reported an increase in their operational footprint. The power sector accounted for roughly 32.9 million tonnes of carbon-dioxide equivalent of a 53.7 million tonne net increase. Energy-intensive industry, in other words, still wrote the national corporate climate path even as software and services filed prettier PDFs.

Scope 3 reporting grew 44 percent year on year — the study called this the single most significant governance improvement of the cycle. Total disclosed Scope 3 reached 1.48 billion tCO₂e. Combined disclosed Scope 1 and 2 stood at 1.31 billion tCO₂e. The value chain, once measured, was already larger than the factory gate. And still 57.1 percent of listed entities did not report Scope 3 data at all.

Clean energy adoption remained structurally low. About 68.43 percent of evaluated companies derived under 20 percent of total energy consumption from renewable sources. Absolute energy consumption was still expanding: 37.58 percent of firms registered a year-on-year increase of more than 10 percent. The study was careful. Despite low baselines, the share of renewable energy was growing faster than overall energy consumption. Energy intensity per rupee of turnover improved. Economic output outpaced energy growth for most reporting firms. Boards would quote intensity. Lenders who had begun to think in financed emissions would still ask about tonnes.

The holes were as important as the totals. 47.15 percent of companies failed to report physical-output energy intensity. Nearly one-third could not provide year-on-year changes in their renewable energy share.

Water made the same argument in a different unit. Industrial water demand was expanding, not contracting. 33.60 percent of companies recorded a water-withdrawal increase of more than 10 percent year

on year. 76.07 percent consumed 80 to 100 percent of the water they withdrew — almost completely consumptive use, with minimal return flows. Wastewater treatment coverage was described as critically inadequate: 77 percent of companies either did not treat their discharge or lacked the metrics to report on it. Only 19.35 percent successfully treated 80 to 100 percent of discharged water. Treatment quality was worsening in a measurable set: 323 companies reported a year-on-year decline of over 10 percent in their treated-discharge ratio.

Rao's own FY 2024–25 BRSR — she had signed the director's responsibility statement with the managing director — reported Scope 1 and 2, a renewable share of 11 percent, and a polite paragraph on "value-chain engagement underway." Scope 3 was blank. The assurer for BRSR Core, when Meridian first crossed into the relevant cohort, had been instructed to stay inside the nine Core attributes and not to go fishing in the supply base. That instruction had felt prudent in 2025. It read differently after IIMB published the national scorecard.

III. The statute that does not wait for a prettier year

SEBI introduced the Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report for the top 1,000 listed entities from FY 2022–23, building on the National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct. On 12 July 2023, circular SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-SEC-2/P/CIR/2023/122 created BRSR Core: a subset of key performance indicators across nine ESG attributes, with a glide path for reasonable assurance — top 150 in FY 2023–24, top 250 in FY 2024–25, top 500 in FY 2025–26, and top 1,000 in FY 2026–27.

The original design also reached into the value chain. Industry pushed back on cost, profession, and the readiness of MSME suppliers. On 18 December 2024 the SEBI Board, citing the Expert Committee for Facilitating Ease of Doing Business and a public consultation, revised the architecture. Subsequent exchange circular language is unambiguous on three points that a CFO can take into a boardroom without a lawyer sitting beside her.

First, listed entities shall mandatorily undertake assessment or assurance of the BRSR Core on the same glide path. The word "or" is the concession. The obligation is not. FY 2026–27 still brings the top 1,000 into the net.

Second, ESG disclosures for the value chain apply to the top 250 listed entities on a voluntary basis from FY 2025–26. Assessment or assurance of those disclosures is voluntary from FY 2026–27. For the first year of value-chain reporting, previous-year comparatives are also voluntary.

Third, the Core itself remains a defined object. Nine attributes. Auditable KPIs. Cross-walked to the full BRSR. Intensity ratios based on revenue adjusted for purchasing-power parity were added to improve global comparability. India-specific KPIs — job creation in small towns, openness of business, gross wages paid to women — sit in the same file as greenhouse-gas totals. A foundry in Jamshedpur is being measured on both.

Rao’s general counsel liked to say that voluntary is a legal category, not a market category. European customers writing contracts under the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive, even after the Omnibus I simplification adopted in February 2026, still asked for supplier data. ISSB IFRS S1 and S2, by September 2026, had been adopted or proposed in more than twenty jurisdictions covering a majority of global GDP; India’s BRSR was being described in public trackers as progressively aligned, with SEBI evaluating convergence pathways. None of that was a SEBI circular. All of it arrived in customer questionnaires.

IV. The bank that reads the same PDF

In May 2026, Climate Risk Horizons published an assessment of 35 Indian banks with a combined market capitalisation of nearly Rs 50 trillion. The study, reported in BW Businessworld, found climate preparedness across the sector “largely compliance-driven rather than strategy-led.” Ninety-two percent of banks now disclosed Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions. Sixty-three percent obtained third-party verification for emissions reporting. Only five banks disclosed financed emissions — the largest source of climate exposure for a lender. Explicit coal phase-out commitments were rare; Federal Bank and RBL Bank were named as having announced them. Union Bank of India had made a limited, non-time-bound pledge.

The Reserve Bank of India had already identified climate risk as a systemic issue and introduced the Climate Risk Information System, RB-CRIS, to improve climate data and risk-assessment capabilities. For a mid-cap borrower, the operational consequence was not a Basel paragraph. It was a longer information memorandum, a request for BRSR extracts, and a relationship manager who had been told to stop treating ESG as a CSR annex.

Meridian’s working-capital line came up for renewal in October. The public-sector bank had not yet published financed-emissions numbers. It had, however, added a clause asking the borrower to “maintain and, on request, share” current BRSR Core metrics and any third-party assessment or assurance report. Rao’s treasurer called it hygiene. Rao called it the beginning of a covenant.

V. Inside Meridian

The numbers below are constructed for teaching. They are directionally consistent with a mid-cap metals and components firm in the IIMB sample. They are not a live filing.

Item	FY24	FY25	Note
Scope 1 + 2 (tCO ₂ e)	186,000	198,400	+6.7%; above the 4.29% all-India rise
Scope 3 disclosed	—	—	Blank, with 57.1% of listed India
Renewable share of energy	9%	11%	Inside the 68.43% under-20% club
Energy use, y/y		+8%	Below the 10% jump bucket
Water withdrawal, y/y		+12%	Inside the 33.60% who rose >10%

Treated discharge ratio	41%	34%	Same direction as the 323 who worsened >10%
BRSR Core assurance	n/a	Limited assessment, Core only	Top-500 adjacency in FY25–26

The heat-treatment capex on the 13 September agenda would raise Scope 1 if the line ran on furnace oil for another five years, and would lower it if the board approved a dual-fuel conversion and a renewable group-captive arrangement the operations director had priced at a 90-basis-point premium to the current landed cost of power. The premium was real. So was the IIMB observation that intensity can improve while tonnes still rise.

Meridian’s top twenty suppliers accounted, on a spend basis, for an estimated 70 percent of purchased goods. Fourteen of the twenty were unlisted MSMEs. None of them filed a BRSR. Two had a single-site energy meter they trusted. The procurement head estimated eighteen months to get usable activity data from the first ten. The Chief Sustainability Officer — a title created in 2024, reporting to the MD, dotted line to Rao — wanted a supplier code, a shared carbon-accounting workbook, and a budget line that finance had not yet opened.

VI. Four rooms, four arguments

The operations director

He had run the shop floor through three commodity cycles. He did not dispute the IIMB water numbers. He disputed the sequence. “If we starve the heat-treatment line to look better on BRSR Core, we miss the export order that pays for the treatment plant.” He wanted the capex approved on throughput and scrap-rate, with energy and water treated as a second paper in Q4.

The promoter-director

She had listed the company and still held the largest block. She read the Climate Risk Horizons piece on banks and asked one question: “Will the renewal price move if we stay silent on Scope 3?” Nobody in the room could answer with a basis point. That, she said, was itself an answer.

The independent director who chairs audit

He had signed enough assurance opinions in another life to distrust both extremes. Assessment-or-assurance, he said, was a drafting kindness. It did not change the board’s duty to know whether the Core KPIs were true. He wanted internal audit to map the nine attributes to process owners before any external firm was briefed. He also wanted a one-page note on what “reasonable assurance” would cost once Meridian was unambiguously inside the top 1,000 for a full financial year.

The CSO

She put IIMB’s 1.48 billion versus 1.31 billion on a slide and refused to take it off. “We can be the 57 percent, or we can be early in the 43 percent. Early is cheaper than late, and it is the only story a European

OEM will underwrite.” She asked for a two-year Scope 3 programme covering purchased goods, upstream transport, and use of sold products for the two automotive platforms that generated 40 percent of revenue.

VII. The decision

Rao has to walk into the 13 September board with a single recommendation, written in language a non-executive can repeat to an analyst. She may combine elements. She may not hide behind “monitor developments.” The four options in the briefing pack are these.

Option A — File and finish. Treat BRSR Core as a compliance file. Commission assessment for FY 2026–27. Leave Scope 3 blank. Approve the heat-treatment line on conventional IRR. Tell the bank the Core report will be shared when issued.

Option B — Open the chain, slowly. Keep Core assessment. Authorise an 18-month Scope 3 build for the top twenty suppliers, with a dedicated analyst in finance — not in the CSO office — and a board review at month nine. Defer any public Scope 3 number until the second year.

Option C — Put carbon in the capital plan. Approve the dual-fuel conversion and the group-captive PPA alongside the heat-treatment line. Publish a three-year climate capital envelope in the annual report. Begin Scope 3 with the two automotive platforms only. Accept a near-term hit to reported energy cost.

Option D — Wait for a peer and a circular. Do A this year. Reopen B and C if a named competitor in the same NSE sector discloses Scope 3, or if SEBI moves value-chain disclosure off the voluntary track.

The chair has asked Rao to state, in one paragraph, which option she will personally defend if an analyst on the Q2 call cites the IIMB study by name.

VIII. What “aligned with ISSB” does not mean

By 1 September 2026, public ISSB trackers described IFRS S1 and S2 as adopted or proposed in more than twenty-one jurisdictions, with more than forty additional jurisdictions in some stage of endorsement. Forbes, writing in early August, put the count of jurisdictions that had adopted the baseline or were writing it into law at forty, covering about sixty percent of world output. Brazil, Chile, Qatar and Mexico were named as having brought rules into force in January. Nigeria was described as committed to a phased transition for public-interest entities.

India’s line in those trackers is careful, and a CFO should keep it careful. BRSR is “progressively aligned.” SEBI is “evaluating convergence pathways” for listed companies. That is not an ISSB mandate. It is also not a private language. Global asset owners who already file under ISSB-aligned rules in Tokyo, Sydney, Singapore or London will read an Indian BRSR with an ISSB template open on the other screen. The mismatch they will notice first is not a missing TCFD diagram. It is a blank Scope 3 table next to a confident net-zero sentence in the chairman’s letter.

A parallel development sits in financial reporting proper. KPMG India’s Accounting and Auditing Update for June 2026 flagged IFRS 9 amendments, effective 1 January 2026, on the classification and measurement

of ESG-linked financial assets, and on renewable-energy contracts such as nature-dependent electricity contracts and power purchase agreements. The same update noted IFRS 18 on presentation of financial statements and management-defined performance measures. KPMG's India-specific observation was modest: ESG-linked financing is not yet common in India, so the IFRS 9 ESG-linked asset amendment would touch a narrower set of entities, particularly banks. For Meridian the relevant clause is the PPA one. If the board chooses Option C, someone in finance must know whether the group-captive arrangement is an executory contract, a lease, or a derivative before the CSO puts "green power" on a slide.

IX. A short history of how we arrived at nine attributes

Students who treat BRSR as a 2021 invention miss the longer Indian argument. The National Voluntary Guidelines on Social, Environmental and Economic Responsibilities of Business, the National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct, the Business Responsibility Report, and then BRSR, are a sequence, not a rebrand. SEBI's contribution in 2021 was to put the top 1,000 listed entities onto a common, structured file and to lodge that file in the annual report. The contribution in July 2023 was to admit that a 100-plus indicator questionnaire would not be assured at scale, and to cut a Core that could be.

The nine attributes are not a random ESG sampler. Greenhouse-gas footprint, water footprint, energy footprint and circularity are the environmental spine. Employee health and safety, gender diversity and inclusive development are the social spine. Customer and supplier engagement and openness of business are the governance-and-market spine, written for an emerging-market context in which related-party opacity and MSME supply bases are not theoretical. PPP-adjusted intensity ratios were added so that a rupee of Indian turnover could be read against a dollar of turnover without a lazy conversion.

Assurance standards in circulation include ISAE 3000, ICAI's SSAE 3000, and SAE 3410 for greenhouse-gas statements. Internal auditors are barred from serving as the assurance provider. The December 2024 easing — assessment or assurance, profession-agnostic — was a response to cost and to the thinness of the assurer market. It was not a finding that the Core KPIs had become less decision-useful.

Value-chain disclosure was the piece that industry fought hardest. The original comply-or-explain timetable was deferred. As of the exchange language implementing the December 2024 Board decision, the top 250 may disclose value-chain ESG data voluntarily from FY 2025–26, and may obtain assessment or assurance of that data voluntarily from FY 2026–27. A student who concludes from that sentence that Scope 3 has been postponed until the 2030s has not read the IIMB totals. The market is already adding the numbers of those who disclose. Silence is a residual.

X. How a mid-cap actually gets a Scope 3 number

Rao asked the CSO to write, in plain language, what "opening Scope 3" would mean for Meridian in the next eighteen months. The note that came back is reproduced here in condensed form. It is a teaching reconstruction of a competent practitioner memo, not a consultancy product.

Category 1, purchased goods and services, would dominate. The top twenty suppliers by spend would be asked for activity data — tonnes of molten metal, tonne-kilometres, kWh — not for a finished ESG brochure. Where a supplier had no meter, Meridian would apply a sector factor and mark the line as estimated. The file would distinguish measured, estimated, and absent. That distinction, the CSO argued, was the entire control environment.

Category 4, upstream transportation, was the second-largest and the most tractable. Meridian already paid the freight bills. Invoices plus a distance matrix plus an emission factor would produce a number a lender could follow. Category 11, use of sold products, was the politically difficult one. Two automotive platforms generated 40 percent of revenue. An OEM customer had already asked, in a 2026 supplier scorecard, for a product-level carbon number. Refusing to compute it internally would not prevent the OEM from computing it externally.

The CSO priced the first-year programme at one additional finance analyst, a shared workbook, two supplier workshops, and a limited review by the existing Core assessor — not a full Scope 3 opinion. She refused to put a rupee figure in the board pack without procurement’s sign-off on supplier coverage. Rao respected the refusal. She also noticed that the note contained no plan for water, even though IIMB’s water chapter was as ugly as its carbon chapter.

XI. Water, which the carbon conversation keeps skipping

Foundries are thirsty in a way that software companies are not. Meridian’s wells and municipal connection had survived two deficient monsoons without a production stoppage. That luck is not a control. IIMB found that 76.07 percent of reporting companies consume 80 to 100 percent of the water they withdraw, and that 77 percent either do not treat discharge or cannot report treatment. Three hundred and twenty-three companies reported a year-on-year decline of over 10 percent in the treated-discharge ratio. Meridian’s own treated-discharge ratio had slipped from 41 percent to 34 percent.

A climate capital plan that buys a renewable PPA and leaves the effluent plant for “later” will survive a first reading by a generalist director. It will not survive a second reading by a credit officer who has been told that physical risk in eastern India is water before it is wind. Rao’s unpublished draft of Option C therefore contains a line the CSO did not write: a sequenced effluent upgrade, staged so that the year-on-year treated-discharge ratio cannot print another decline in FY 2026–27. She has not yet decided whether that line is courage or decoration.

XII. What the twenty minutes must produce

Boards do not adopt philosophies. They adopt minutes. Rao’s working draft of the minute, which she has not shown anyone, reads as follows. Students may amend it or reject it. They may not leave it blank.

“The Board noted the IIM Bangalore Supply Chain Management Centre analysis of 982 BRSR filings for FY 2024–25, and the SEBI glide path under which assessment or assurance of BRSR Core extends to the top

1,000 listed entities in FY 2026–27. The Board asked the CFO to (i) map the nine Core attributes to process owners before 30 September; (ii) place a Scope 3 scoping paper — purchased goods, upstream transport, use of sold products — before the Audit Committee in November; (iii) bring the heat-treatment capex back with a dual-fuel and group-captive option priced on a like-for-like IRR; and (iv) share the current Core assessment with the working-capital bank as a matter of course, not as a concession.”

That draft is closer to Option B married to a slice of C than to A or D. It spends political capital. It does not yet spend much cash. Whether it is enough, on a morning when 57.1 percent of listed India is still silent on the larger inventory of tonnes, is the question the class is hired to answer.

Assignment Questions

1. Separate what IIMB measured from what the Business Today headline compressed. Why does a 4.29 percent rise in absolute Scope 1+2 coexist with a “53 percent jump” in the public conversation? Which number should a CFO put on page one of a board note, and why?
2. Scope 3 disclosed (1.48 billion tCO₂e) already exceeds combined Scope 1+2 (1.31 billion), yet 57.1 percent of filers report nothing. Is that a data problem, a governance problem, or a capital-market problem? Defend one primary diagnosis with the SEBI value-chain rules as they stood after December 2024.
3. SEBI replaced “reasonable assurance” with “assessment or assurance.” Does that change the audit committee’s workplan, the CFO’s representation letter, both, or neither?
4. Using only the public bank evidence in this case (Climate Risk Horizons; RBI’s identification of climate as systemic; RB-CRIS), construct the most conservative and the most aggressive story a relationship manager could tell the credit committee about Meridian in October 2026.
5. Intensity per rupee of turnover improved even as tonnes and water withdrawal rose for large shares of the sample. Write the two-sentence explanation you would give a sell-side ESG analyst who treats intensity as a substitute for absolute reduction.
6. Recommend A, B, C, D, or a named hybrid. State the effect on next year’s reported energy cost, on the working-capital conversation, and on the FY 2026–27 BRSR Core file.

You Are the CFO

Close the laptop. You have twenty minutes in a board that already thinks it understands ESG because it approved a tree-planting budget in 2022. You must leave the room with a minuted decision, not a task force. Write, in not more than 400 words:

(a) the recommendation you will speak; (b) the one IIMB or SEBI fact you will put on the screen and refuse to take off; (c) the control you want internal audit to own before any assurer is hired; and (d) the sentence you will use on the analyst call if someone quotes “53 percent.” Do not invent a tonne, a rupee, or a circular that is not in the sources.

Pedagogical note

This case is written for a 75-minute MBA or professional-CFO seminar. Suggested split: 15 minutes on the IIMB arithmetic, 15 on the SEBI glide path and the December 2024 easing, 15 on the bank channel, 20 on the four options, 10 on the representation a CFO actually signs. Instructors should refuse any student answer that treats “voluntary value-chain disclosure” as “Scope 3 does not exist.” They should also refuse any answer that treats the Business Today headline as a substitute for the underlying 4.29 percent and 53.1 percent distinction.

Core philosophy of the series: AI generates. DATA informs. FINANCE measures. ACCOUNTING verifies. HUMAN JUDGMENT decides.

Sources

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- Institute of Chartered Accountants of India. Guidance material on BRSR Core assurance standards and mapping to BRSR principles.

A last walk through the plant

At 8:55 a.m. Rao left the printouts on the passenger seat and walked the short distance from the admin block to the older bay. The night shift had left a ladle that still held heat. Nobody on that floor had read IIMB. Everybody on that floor knew when the municipal tanker was late. She stood long enough to remember that a case study is a courtesy. The tonnes do not wait for a teaching note.

The Future CFO of 2035 will have better tools. IIMB's own Centre has already built a carbon-accounting tool covering Scope 1, 2 and 3 with a BRSR Core overlay, and a transportation-emission measurement tool.

Those instruments will not choose Option A or Option C. A human being with a signature block will. That is why this series exists, and why the last line of every episode is the same.

AI generates. DATA informs. FINANCE measures. ACCOUNTING verifies. HUMAN JUDGMENT decides.

Exhibit A — BRSR Core glide path (public)

FY 2023–24: top 150 listed entities by market capitalisation. FY 2024–25: top 250. FY 2025–26: top 500. FY 2026–27: top 1,000. From the December 2024 Board decision onward, the mandated external work on the Core is assessment or assurance. Value-chain ESG disclosure: top 250, voluntary from FY 2025–26. Assessment or assurance of value-chain disclosure: voluntary from FY 2026–27. Source: SEBI 12 July 2023 circular and NSE ESG circular implementing the 18 December 2024 Board decision.

Exhibit B — IIMB sample construction (public)

Universe: top 1,000 listed Indian companies under the BRSR mandate. Effective sample: 982 companies with valid and sufficiently complete FY 2024–25 filings lodged with the NSE. Classification: 22 sectors, NSE standardised framework. Design: sector performance benchmarked against the all-India distribution across 21 ESG parameters (7 environmental, 7 social, 7 governance). Source: IIMB SCMC monograph record, 1 August 2026.

Exhibit C — Figures used in this case, with their public home

4.29% rise in absolute Scope 1+2; 53.1% of companies with a higher operational footprint; 32.9 million tCO₂e of a 53.7 million tCO₂e net increase attributable to power; Scope 3 disclosed 1.48 billion tCO₂e versus Scope 1+2 of 1.31 billion; Scope 3 reporting +44% year on year; 57.1% non-reporting on Scope 3; 68.43% under 20% renewable energy share; 37.58% with energy use up more than 10%; 47.15% missing physical-output energy intensity; 33.60% with water withdrawal up more than 10%; 76.07% consuming 80–100% of withdrawn water; 77% untreated or unreported discharge; 19.35% treating 80–100% of discharge; 323 companies with treated-discharge ratio down more than 10%. All from Business Today's 30 August 2026 report of the IIMB study. Bank figures (92%, 63%, five banks, Federal and RBL, Rs 50 trillion, 35 banks) from BW Businessworld's report of Climate Risk Horizons. No other quantitative claim in this case should be treated as a measured national statistic.

Exhibit D — Teaching composite versus live filing

Meridian Castings Limited, Ananya Rao, and the internal table in Section V are composites. They exist so that a class can decide. They are calibrated to sit inside the IIMB distributions (operational emissions up, renewable share under 20%, water withdrawal up more than 10%, treated-discharge ratio worsening). They are not the accounts of a named issuer. Instructors who wish to substitute a live BRSR should pick a mid-cap metals or auto-ancillary filer from the NSE archive and replace Section V only. Sections II, III, IV, VIII and the Exhibits should remain untouched, because those sections are the public record.

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